At Gateshead

[Jane Eyre is ten years old. Both her parents are dead. She lives with her aunt, Mrs. Reed, and three cousins, Eliza, John and Georgiana. Bessie is the servant maid.]

Bessie : Miss. Jane, keep out of **mischiefs** today. Mrs. Reed is in a frightful mood at breakfast this morning.

Jane : Oh, she never takes notice of me anymore. I think she hides in the sitting room if she hears me coming down the stairs.

Bessie : I am speaking of Miss. Georgiana and Eliza. No quarrelling with those two or you will have the whole house in **uproar**.

Jane : Oh, it's not me who starts it. I'll hide myself in the library with Uncle Reed's book.

[Jane sits on the floor and looks through a picture book. John, Georgiana and Eliza come.]

John : Here she is.

Jane : What do you want?

John : How dare to ask me, what do you want? Come here when I call you.

Eliza : What are you reading now?

Jane : Bewicks's History of British Birds.

John : Show me.

Eliza : It's one of father's books. You know, not one of these books belongs to you.

John : Bring it to me here.

[Jane rises and cautiously goes to John.]

John : You have no business to take our books. You are a **dependant**. You have no money. Your father left you none. You ought to beg not to live here with gentlemen's children like us. Go, stand by the door there, out of the way of the mirror and the windows.

[Jane moves a few steps away, John throws the book at her. John runs towards Jane and grasps her hair and shoulder. He hits her with something. One or two drops of blood from her head trickle down her neck. Eliza **screams**. Bessie and Mrs. Reed come.]

Bessie : Dear! Dear! What fury to fly at Master. John like this!

Mrs. Reed : Frightful child! Take her away in the red room and lock her in there!

Bessie : But, Mrs. Reed…

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